

Lochmaster 4.0: Developers' Tool for Strip Board Projects

Young engineering minds always have a lot of innovative design ideas. Unfortunately, they might not always be able to materialise those in a PCB design because they take more time, consume more money and they cannot always reuse and redesign the board. As an ideal developer's tool for freshers in electronics design, the Lochmaster helps in design, documentation and testing of project boards

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The world of electronics is so fascinating that once you begin designing something on your own, you will no longer be satisfied with the breadboards. You need your designs to last forever. The obvious choice of most of the designers is to go for PCBs. Unfortunately, in many cases going for PCBs is not the best option. It can drain your savings, time and ultimately, by the time the PCB reaches your hand, you might lose interest in the project itself.

Strip board is a good option but it becomes difficult when it comes to complex circuits. Use of a software-aided strip board design will be the best option to reduce the overall complexity. As a beginner, you do not want your software to be too complex. Lochmaster v4.0 software from Abacom is an exceptionally simple and easy-to-use developer's tool for strip board projects.

Features of LochMaster 4.0

Let us take a look at the features of LochMaster 4.0 that we found to be interesting.

Easy-to-use design environment. LochMaster 4.0 can help us in designing, documenting and testing project boards. In order to increase the overall

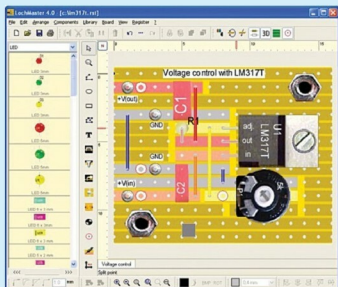


Fig. 1: Interconnections of components in a Lochmaster display

simplicity of the tool, functions like auto-generation of components lists, a connection test, an editable library with a large number of symbols and components are incorporated in the tool.

The developers' tool also has the provision of an integrated board editor. In case our desired board is not predefined, we can use the integrated board editor to create our own boards. Another major advantage with LochMaster 4.0 is its backward compatibility. We can load and edit any project we have already designed with LochMaster.

Realistic component library. The component library in LochMaster4.0 is very large and realistic. Apart from having the standard components like resistors, diodes and capacitors, the library also has a lot of mechanical elements like screws, nuts and spacers that makes it more realistic.

The new, extended library looks almost like real components. Besides this, there is a whole new set of practical features like parallel usage of mm and hole grids. Altogether, you can have a display similar to that of a real board. This feature is not only good to visualise but also helps us have clarity in our design.

We also have the provision for designing our own components and symbols using this developers' tool. We can extend the library as we like. LochMaster 4.0 provides us with an easy-to-create standard components or often-needed contours with the help of